

Road to Erasmus Mundus

From Sylhet Engineering College to Europe,
Gourab Roy,
IPCVAI Scholar



What We'll Cover

01

The Program

Program, eligibility & why apply

02

My Journey

Profile, documents & strategy

03

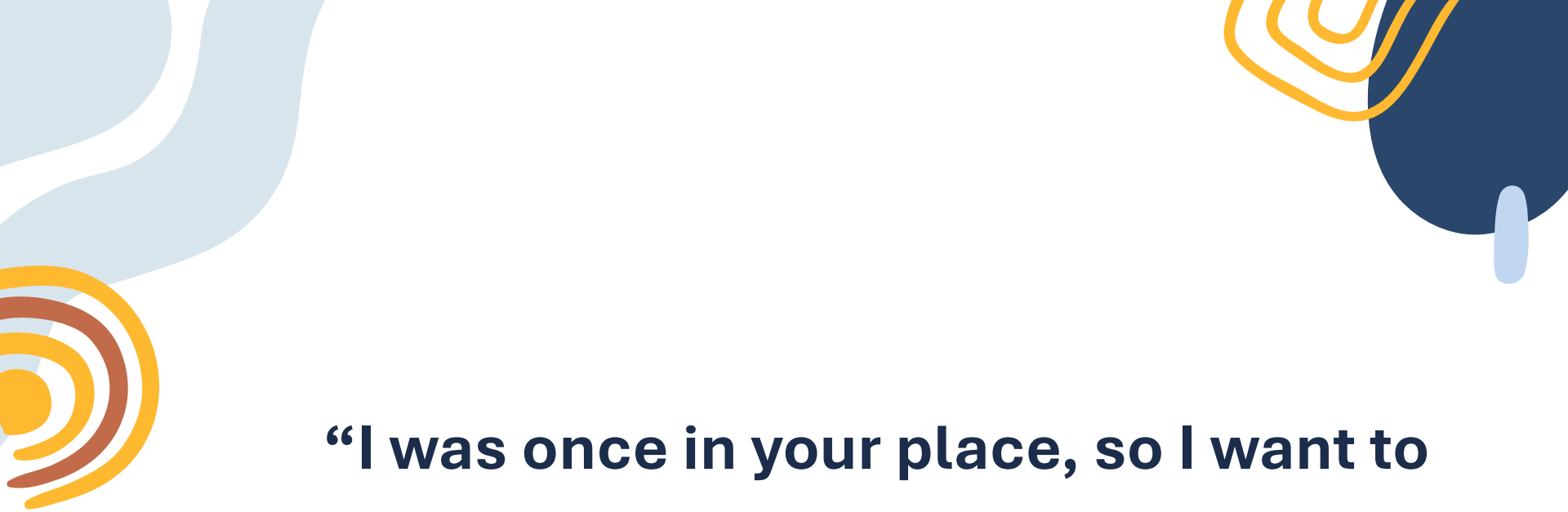
Practical Advice

Planning, mistakes & tips

04

Life in Europe

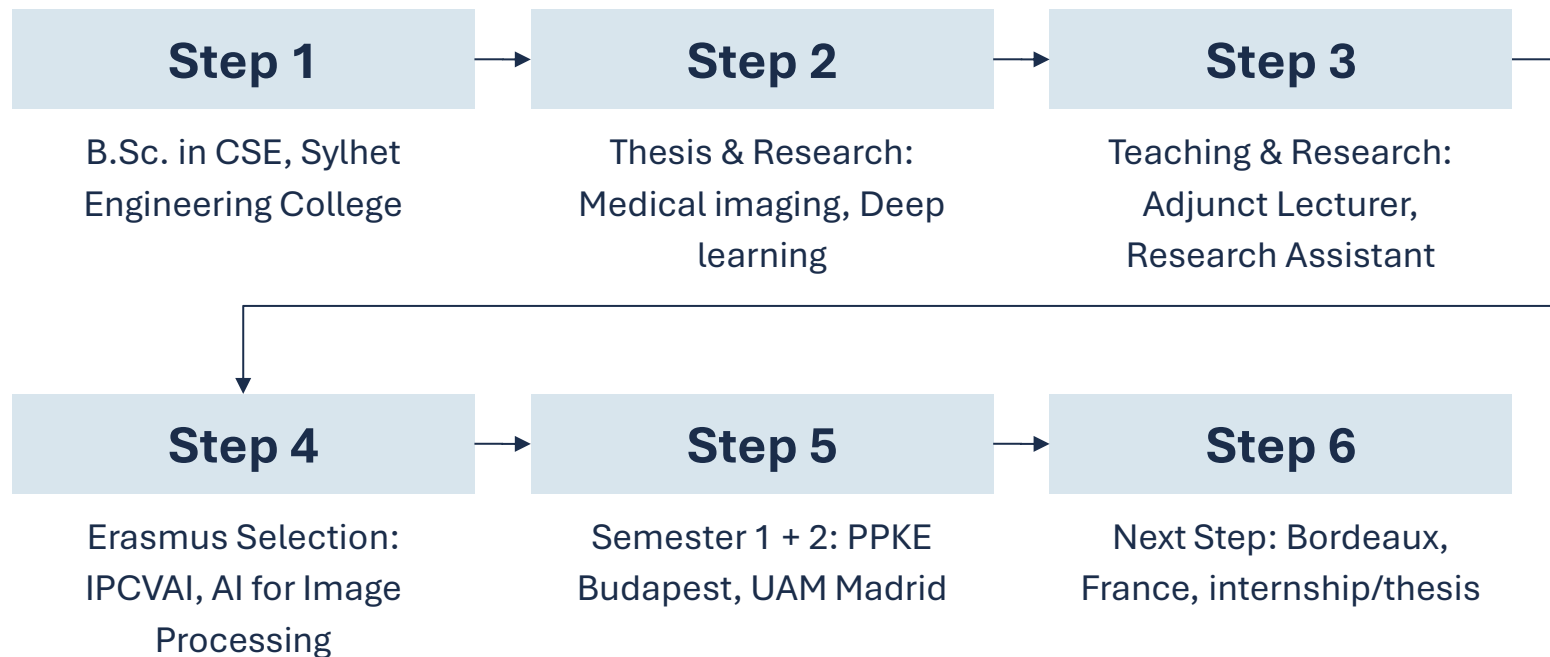
Budapest, Madrid & Bordeaux



**“I was once in your place, so I want to
make the path clearer for you.”**

—Gourab Roy

My Journey at a Glance





01

The Program

What it is, why it matters, and how to build a strong application

What is Erasmus Mundus?



Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters are international master's programs jointly delivered by European universities, where students study across multiple countries with strong academic, cultural, and research exposure.



Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters combine strong academic exposure, multi-country mobility, and scholarship support, giving students a globally connected and research-driven education across partner universities.



Why Should You Apply?



- 
1. **Multi-Country Study:** Study in 2 or more European countries
 2. **Strong Academic Exposure:** Different universities and teaching systems
 3. **Funding Opportunities:** Tuition, allowance, travel, and insurance support.
 4. **Global Cohort:** Classmates from many countries around the world.
 5. **Career & Research Growth:** Academic, research, and professional opportunities.
 6. **Bottom Line:** For many students, this can be a life-changing academic opportunity.
- 

Is It Competitive?



Global Competition

Applicants come from many countries



Limited Seats

Only a small number of seats per program



Strong Profile Matters

Grades, research, projects, CV, and letter count



Program Fit Important

Best fit clearly matches the program's goals



Who Should Apply?

1. **Academic Consistency:** Good grades and strong basics
2. **Clear Motivation:** You know why you want this field
3. **Relevant Experience:** Projects, thesis, research, internship, or teaching
4. **Adaptability:** Ready for new countries, cultures, and systems
5. **Pressure Handling:** Manage deadlines, exams, and uncertainty
6. **Remember:** You don't need a perfect profile, you need a clear story and consistency

Candidate Types



The Academic

Strong CGPA basics and a clean transcript



The Engineer

Projects, coding skills, and GitHub work



The Researcher

Thesis, publications, and program fit



The Balanced Candidate

Grades plus projects plus motivation together

My Profile Before Applying



Academic Background

SEC- CGAP: 3.56/4.00



Thesis: CerebralNet

Brain imaging & classification and
Detection



Research & Publications

Medical imaging, CV,
OCR, ML



Teaching Experience

Adjunct Lecturer, CSE
Dept.



Projects & Skills

Deep learning, CV, NLP,
PyTorch



English Proficiency

IELTS

What Helped Most

1. **Program Fit:** Background matched Image Processing, Computer Vision, and AI
2. **Research Direction:** Thesis and projects connected to medical imaging and deep learning
3. **Publications & Projects:** Showed consistency and research interest
4. **Teaching Experience:** Communication and academic maturity
5. **Motivation Letter:** Past work, interest, and future goals connected
6. **Key Takeaway:** Not a perfect profile, but a connected and focused story

What I Would Improve

1. **Start Earlier:** Prepare CV, documents, and English test before application season
2. **Target Programs Better:** Apply where your background and goals strongly match
3. **Polish the CV More:** Short, academic, and focused on relevant work only
4. **Customize Each Letter:** Avoid generic letters; connect your profile with each program
5. **Track Everything:** Use a spreadsheet for deadlines, documents, and status
6. **Bottom Line:** Selection is also about being organized, not only being qualified

How the Application Differs

Aspect	General Application	Erasmus Mundus Application
Program choice	Apply to one university or a single program.	Apply to a joint master's program.
Funding	Scholarship or funding is handled separately.	Scholarship is considered with the same application.
Study path	Usually study in one country or one university.	Study across multiple universities and countries.

Documents You Need

1. **Academic CV:** Europass or clean academic CV
2. **Motivation Letter:** Program-specific and personal
3. **Recommendation Letters:** Usually 2 letters from teachers or supervisors
4. **Transcript & Certificate:** Bachelor's transcript and degree certificate
5. **English Proficiency:** IELTS, TOEFL, or accepted English certificate
6. **Passport & Application Form:** Valid passport, plus the online form via the program website

The Motivation Letter

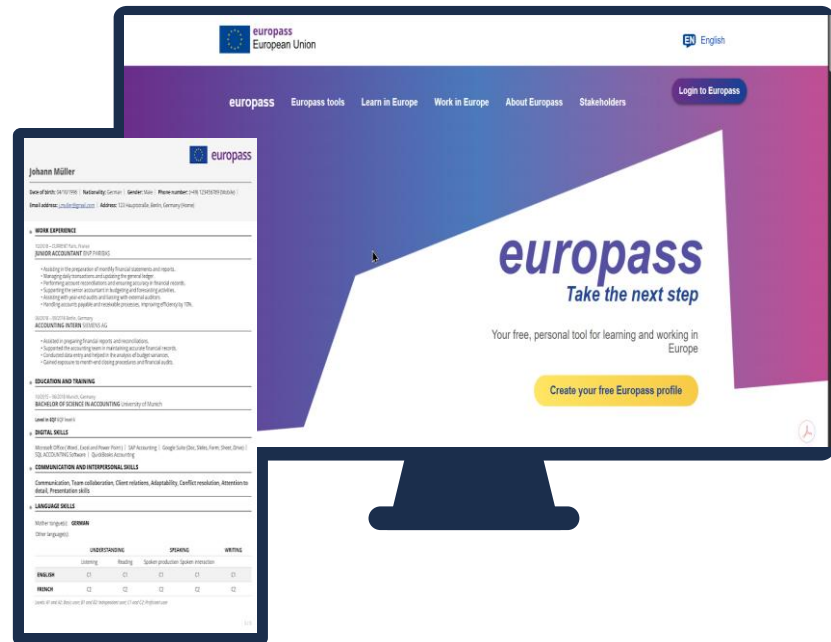
1. **My Background:** Academic history, thesis, projects, research, skills
2. **Why This Field:** Clear interest in the subject area
3. **Why This Program:** Courses, mobility, universities, research fit
4. **Future Goal:** Academic, research, or professional direction
5. **Avoid Generic Letters:** No specific program connection, same letter sent everywhere
6. **Avoid Pure Emotion:** An emotional story alone, without showing program fit, isn't enough

Recommendation Letters

1. **Choose the Right Person:** Teacher, supervisor, or project mentor who knows your work
2. **Ask Early:** Contact them well before the deadline, not at the last moment
3. **Supporting Materials:** CV, transcript, motivation letter draft, and program details
4. **Make It Specific:** Skills, projects, academic performance, and potential
5. **Specific Examples:** A good LOR cites real examples of your work and research
6. **Clear Field Connection:** Links your background to the program with a realistic recommendation

CV for Erasmus Mundus

Use the Europass format (europass.europa.eu), max 2 pages, so the committee grasps your profile in one minute. Add a professional photo and use CEFR levels for languages.



Choosing the Right Program

1

Field Match

Program matches your background and interests

2

Course Structure

Courses, specialisations, thesis options

3

Mobility Path

Countries, universities, semester locations

4

Scholarship Status

Is Erasmus+ funding open for this intake?

5

Eligibility

Degree, English score, documents, deadline

6

Future Goal

Research, PhD, industry, or career direction?

7

Note

Apply only when you can clearly explain why the program is right for you.

Selection Steps



Interests

Identify your field and academic background



Check Fit

Verify field, courses, mobility, scholarship, eligibility, and goals



Shortlist

Find programs that match your profile



Apply

Apply with a clear, well-explained fit narrative

Best Fields for CSE Students

1. **Artificial Intelligence:** ML, Deep Learning, Computer Vision, NLP
2. **Data Science & Analytics:** Big data, statistics, decision support, visualization
3. **Cybersecurity & Cloud:** Network security, cryptography, cloud computing, IoT
4. **Software Engineering:** Intelligent and green software systems
5. **Robotics & Embedded:** Autonomous systems, IoT devices, edge AI
6. **Medical Imaging:** Healthcare AI, imaging, biomedical data

Programs Worth Checking

1. **IPCVAI:** AI for Image Processing and Computer Vision
2. **EMAI:** Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters in Artificial Intelligence
3. **CoDaS & BDMA:** Data Science/Communication, Big Data Management & Analytics
4. **EDISS:** Engineering of Data-intensive Intelligent Software Systems
5. **SECCLO & CyberMACS:** Security & Cloud Computing, Applied Cybersecurity
6. **IFROS:** Intelligent Field Robotic Systems

My Program: IPCVAI



Field

AI, Image Processing, Computer Vision



Mobility

Hungary, then Spain, then France



Academic Focus

Deep Learning, Medical Imaging, XAI

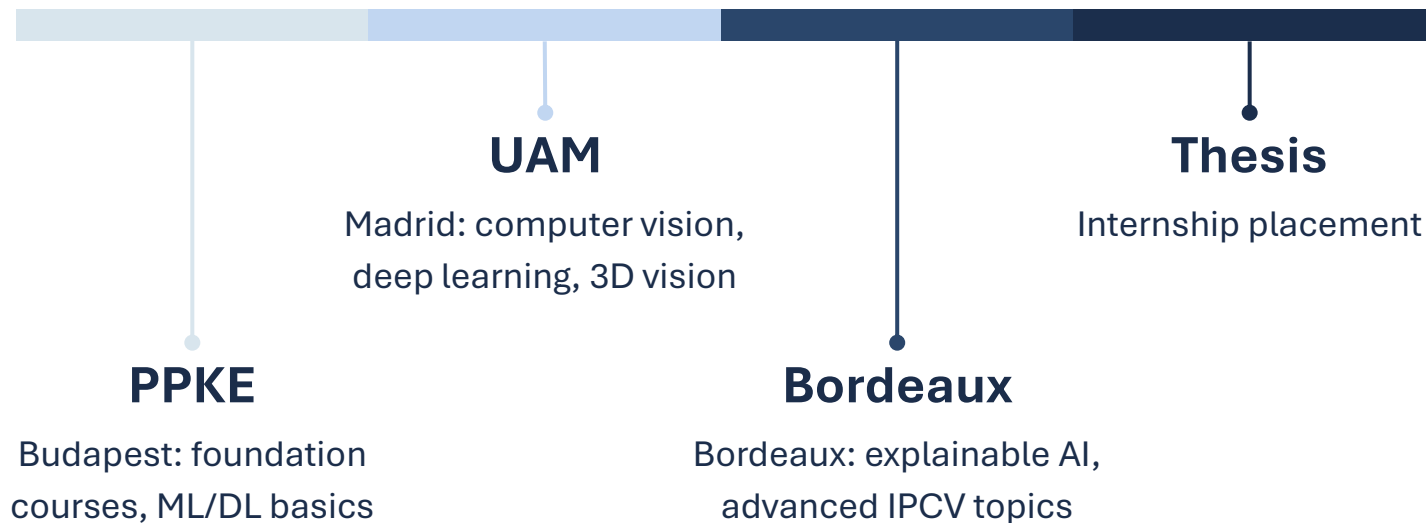


Why It Matched Me

CSE background, medical imaging, AI and CV interest



IPCVAI Mobility Path





02

Life Abroad

Two completed semesters in Budapest and Madrid, and what
they taught me

Semester 1: PPKE Budapest

1. **New Academic System:** Different teaching style, grading, assignments, expectations
2. **Core Technical Courses:** Image processing, machine learning, deep learning, multimodal systems
3. **International Classroom:** Classmates from different countries and academic backgrounds
4. **Independent Learning:** More responsibility for self-study, deadlines, and problem solving
5. **Life in Budapest:** New culture, transport, weather, food, housing, and adaptation
6. **Takeaway:** Getting selected is only the beginning, adapting well is the real challenge

Semester 1: The Challenges



Academic Pressure

New exam style,
expectations



Time Pressure

Courses, labs, and
deadlines



Living Alone

Cooking, cleaning,
budgeting



Weather & Culture

Winter, language, new
culture



Admin Work

Permit, insurance,
housing



Mental Adjustment

Missing home, staying
calm

Semester 1: What I Learned

1. **Academic Independence:** You have to take responsibility for your own learning
2. **Time Management:** Deadlines, exams, assignments, and personal life need planning
3. **Asking for Help:** Seniors, classmates, teachers, and coordinators can make life easier
4. **International Collaboration:** Working with people from different countries builds confidence
5. **Adaptability:** New country, new weather, new system, you slowly learn to adjust
6. **Mindset Shift:** Survival comes first, then improvement comes naturally

Semester 2: UAM Madrid

1. **Advanced Technical Courses:** Deep learning, computer vision, 3D vision, visual signal processing
2. **Project-Based Learning:** Assignments, experiments, coding tasks, and presentations
3. **Research Direction:** TRDP work on Explainable AI, CLIP, BERT, and attention filtering
4. **Academic Pressure:** Exams, deadlines, reports, and multiple submissions
5. **Life in Madrid:** New city, language, transport, classmates, cultural experience
6. **Takeaway:** Erasmus Mundus also means handling real academic pressure abroad

Semester 2: Academic Reality

1

Technical Depth

Strong math and coding basics

2

Continuous Deadlines

Labs, reports, and exams together

3

Self-Learning

Papers, code, and tools independently

4

Project Pressure

Experiments matter more than theory

5

Communication

Presenting ideas clearly matters too

6

Consistency

Small weekly progress beats cramming

7

Note

Talent helps, but consistency saves you

Semester 2: TRDP Research



1. **Research Area:** Explainable AI for multimodal models
2. **Technical Focus:** CLIP, BERT, attention maps, and statistical filtering
3. **Experimentation:** Reproducing methods, testing variants, analyzing outputs
4. **Supervisor Meetings:** Weekly discussions, feedback, corrections, and next steps
5. **Research Communication:** Reports, slides, presentations, explaining results clearly
6. **Research Flow:** Idea, literature, experiments, results, then presentation

Life in Europe



Food & Cooking

Cooking, finding
halal/deshi food



Housing

Rent, deposit, shared
living



Transport

Metro, bus, and train



Language & Culture

New languages and
customs



Friends & Community

International classmates



Loneliness

Missing home, new
routine

Money and Funding Reality

1. **Scholarship Types:** Full scholarship, partial support, fee waiver, or self-funded option
2. **Living Costs Vary:** Budapest, Madrid, Bordeaux can have very different expenses
3. **First-Month Cost:** Housing deposit, travel, SIM card, transport pass, basic setup
4. **Monthly Budgeting:** Rent, food, transport, mobile, study materials, emergency money
5. **Mobility Expenses:** Moving between countries, luggage, flights, new housing setup
6. **Plan Ahead:** Calculate scholarship plus savings minus expected expenses before accepting

Travel & Mobility

1. **Between Countries:** Planning flights, trains, luggage, dates, and arrival time
2. **Documents:** Visa, residence permit, insurance, university letters, registration
3. **Housing Search:** Finding accommodation before arrival, checking contracts carefully
4. **Luggage Planning:** Carry only the essentials; moving differs from normal travel
5. **New City Setup:** SIM card, transport pass, grocery shops, bank, daily routine
6. **Emotional Adaptation:** Every move means leaving one comfort zone, building another

What Nobody Tells You

1

First Month Is Hard

New country, documents, housing, routine

2

Admin Takes Time

Permit, insurance, housing papers

3

Stay Independent

No one reminds you, track your own tasks

4

Academic Pressure

Courses, labs, exams can all overlap

5

Loneliness Can Happen

Missing family and culture shock

6

Plans Can Change

Housing, travel, and schedules may shift

7

Note

The good news: you slowly grow stronger

Things That Made Life Easier

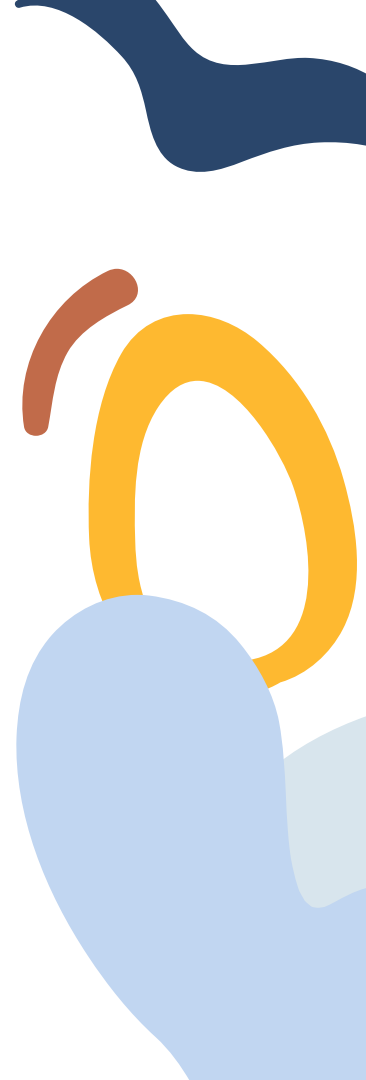
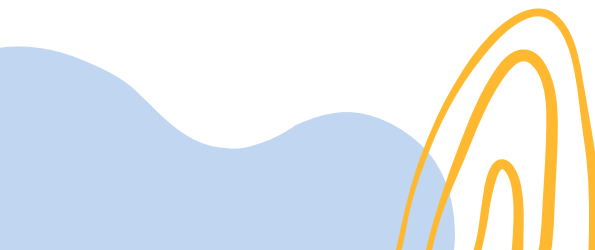
1. **Staying Organized:** Tracking deadlines, documents, exams, housing, and travel plans
2. **Asking Seniors:** Seniors can guide you on courses, housing, documents, city life
3. **Building Friendships:** Classmates and local communities make adaptation easier
4. **Keeping a Routine:** Study time, cooking, sleep, exercise, personal tasks need balance
5. **Communicating Early:** Email coordinators and teachers before problems become serious
6. **Accept Imperfection:** Not everything will go perfectly, adjust, learn, and continue



03

Planning

Timelines, tracking, common mistakes, and advice for SEC students



Application Timeline





Application Tracking System

Track program, field, deadline, motivation letter status, recommenders, documents, and result for every application in one spreadsheet.

Application Tracking System							
Program	Field	Deadline	Mot. Ltr	Recomm.	Docs	Status	Result
IPCVAI	AI / CV	15 Jan	Ready	2 / 2	4 / 4	Submitted	Selected
EMAI	AI	20 Jan	Draft	1 / 2	3 / 4	In Progress	Pending
BDMA	Data Science	28 Feb	Ready	2 / 2	4 / 4	Interview	Pending
SECCLO	Cloud / Security	10 Mar	Started	0 / 2	1 / 4	Planning	—

Common Mistakes by Applicants



Generic Motivation Letter

Same letter sent
everywhere

Random Program Pick

Applying for a famous
name only

Weak CV Structure

Too long and not well
focused

Late LOR Request

Asking too close to
deadline

Ignoring Eligibility

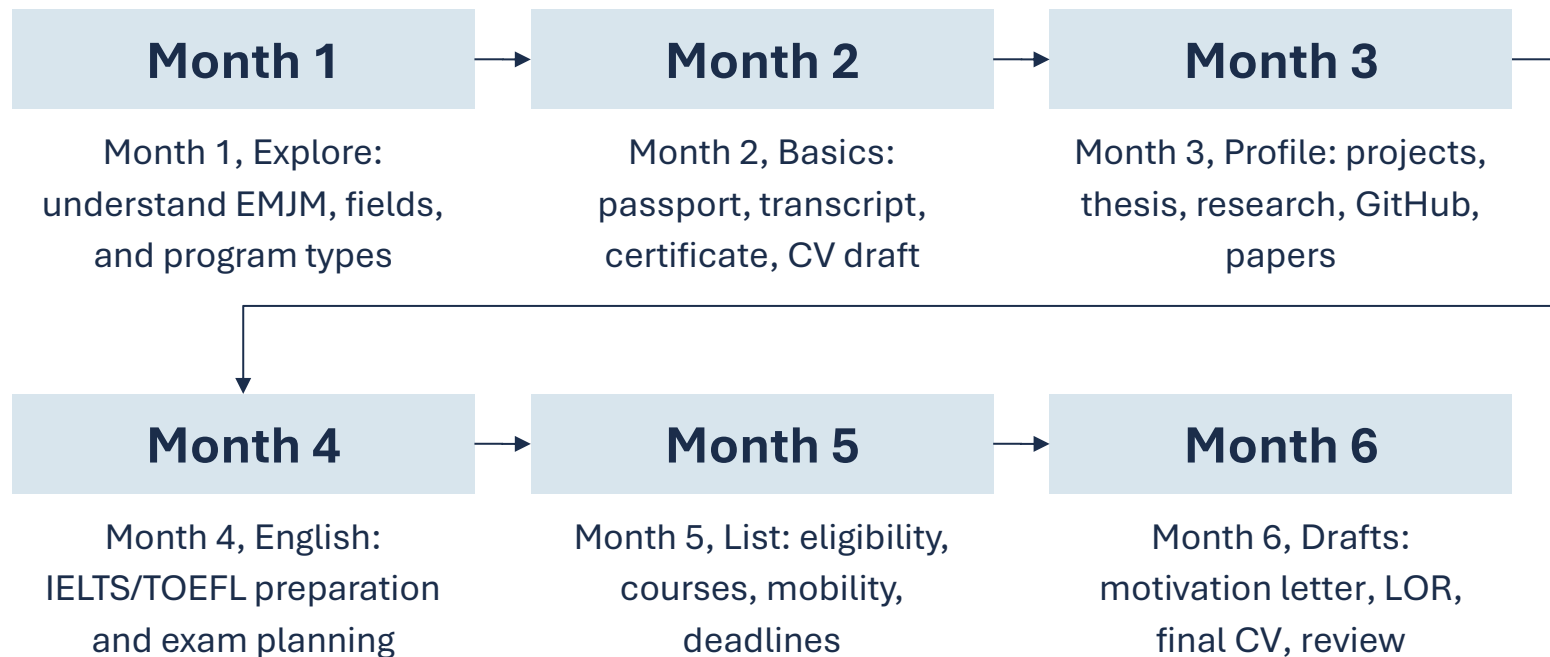
Missing background or
English score

Last-Minute Submit

No review or deadline
buffer



6-Month Action Plan



My Advice for You Guys

1. **Start Early:** Do not wait until final year or the application deadline
2. **Relevant Projects:** Choose projects connected to your target field of study
3. **Value Your Thesis:** A good thesis can become a strong part of your application story
4. **Improve Your English:** Prepare for IELTS/TOEFL and practice academic writing
5. **Make Your CV Clean:** Highlight education, thesis, projects, research, and achievements
6. **Ask for Guidance:** Talk to teachers, seniors, selected scholars, and current students

Useful Links & Resources

1

Erasmus Catalogue:

Official program search portal:

eacea.ec.europa.eu

2

Program Websites:

Eligibility, deadlines, documents, and scholarships

3

Europass CV:

CV format and profile building:

europass.europa.eu

4

IELTS / TOEFL:

English proficiency prep:

ielts.org and ets.org/toefl

5

Sheets / Notion:

Application tracking:

sheets.google.com or notion.so

6

Seniors & Scholars:

Real experience, guidance, and review support

The background features abstract, organic shapes in shades of blue and yellow. In the top left, there's a blue shape with a yellow line. In the top right, a yellow shape with a blue line. In the bottom left, a yellow shape with a blue line. In the bottom right, a blue shape with a yellow line. The text is centered in the middle of the page.

Preparation Matters

Most

Q&A

**Do you have any questions? Thank you for having me,
Gourab Roy, IPCVAI Erasmus Mundus Joint Master**

[Mailto: gourabroysec553@gmail.com](mailto:gourabroysec553@gmail.com)

[Personal Portfolio : gourabroy551.github.io](https://gourabroy551.github.io)
github.com/GourabRoy551

